

Art Nouveau

Spanning the quarter-century from 1890 until the outbreak of war, art nouveau was arguably the first avant-garde architectural style, and it manifested in all areas of design, from architecture to the fine and decorative arts. Art nouveau architects rejected revivalism and historicism, and instead embraced a completely new aesthetic that featured asymmetry, flowing lines, whiplash curves, organic forms, symbolism and new materials such as iron and glass. Architectural interpretations include the Hôtel Tassel (completed in 1893) in Belgium, designed by Victor Horta (1861–1947), designs for entrances to the Paris Métro (1899–1905) by Hector Guimard, the Secession House in Vienna (1896) by Joseph Maria Olbrich (1867–1908), the Glasgow School of Art (1897–1909) in Scotland by Charles Rennie Mackintosh, and La Sagrada Familia (begun 1882) in Spain, designed by Antoni Gaudí. Art nouveau came under a range of names, from *Jugendstil* (Germany) to *stile floreale* or *stile liberte* (Italy) and *modernismo* (Spain).



Majolikahaus in Vienna, Wagner, 1898